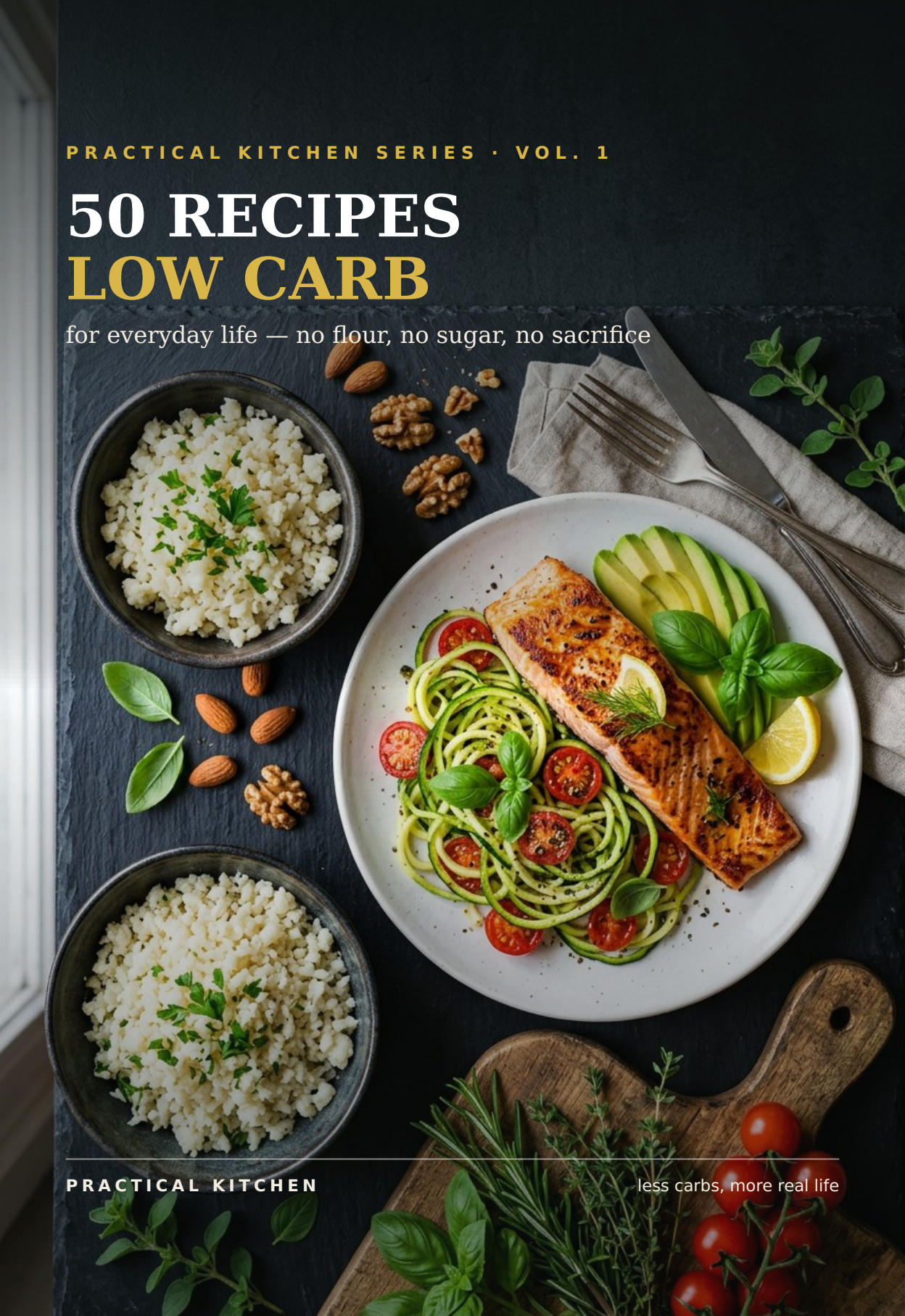
PRACTICAL KITCHEN SERIES · VOL. 1

50 RECIPES LOW CARB

for everyday life — no flour, no sugar, no sacrifice



PRACTICAL KITCHEN

less carbs, more real life

Credits and Legal Notice

50 Low-Carb Recipes for Everyday Life — 1st edition, 2026.
Practical Kitchen Series · volume 1.

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> **IMPORTANT NOTICE:** nutritional information (calories, carbohydrates, protein and fat) is an **estimate per serving**, calculated from the ingredient list and food-composition tables. Values vary by brand, ingredient size, and equipment. This book is educational and **does not replace** advice from a doctor or a registered dietitian. People with diabetes, kidney disease, pregnant or breastfeeding people and anyone taking continuous medication should consult a qualified professional before adopting a carbohydrate-restricted eating pattern. Erythritol and xylitol are safe for most people in moderate amounts; excess may cause digestive discomfort. Xylitol is toxic to dogs — keep desserts away from pets.

Measurements used in this book: 1 cup = 240 ml · 1 tbsp = 15 ml · 1 tsp = 5 ml · a level tablespoon is not heaped · ovens are preheated unless stated otherwise.

Layout and illustrative photographs created for editorial purposes.

Welcome to Your Low-Carb Kitchen

You did not buy a diet book. You bought **50 ready-to-use answers** to the question that can derail any eating routine: “What should I cook today?”.

Low carb does not mean living on sad salads. It means enjoying a creamy omelette, a lasagne you can slice, a Sunday feijoada, and even cheesecake — swapping refined flour and sugar for ingredients that satisfy, without cooking two separate meals.

Every recipe was selected for three reasons: **easy-to-find ingredients**, **realistic time for busy people**, and **leftovers that solve tomorrow’s meal**.

> **The golden rule of this book:** carbohydrates are accents, not the foundation. They add flavour and colour — tomato, carrot, fruit — while the foundation is always protein, good fat and vegetables.

Cook one new recipe a day for seven weeks and you will have a repertoire that can rescue any Monday. Enjoy.

How to Use This Book

1. Start at the end. Check the “7-Day Menu” bonus and the shopping list before you go to the shops. Cooking without a plan is the fastest way to order a takeaway on Thursday.

2. Double the right recipe. Most lunch and dinner recipes make two servings: the second becomes tomorrow’s lunch.

3. Use the boxes. Each recipe includes a **Cooking Tip** and a **Smart Swap** to help you adapt without leaving the low-carb approach.

4. Do not chase zero carbs. The nutritional numbers are there to help you choose, not to turn food into a prison.

5. Freeze with confidence. Recipes with freezing notes were designed for individual portions and sealed containers.

Substitutions That Save Any Pantry

Low carb is also a game of smart swaps. Keep this table handy:

Remove	Use instead	Note
Refined sugar	**Erythritol or xylitol**	1:1; xylitol is slightly sweeter
Wheat flour	**Almond flour + 1 egg**	use half the amount; egg provides structure
White rice	**Cauliflower rice**	sauté raw over high heat for 5–6 minutes
Pasta	**Courgette, hearts of palm or konjac**	sauté for 90 seconds to 3 minutes
Potato	**Cauliflower, turnip or roasted radish**	for mash and soups; use pumpkin moderately
Prepared sauce	**Peeled tomatoes + seasoning**	simmer over low heat for 20 minutes

Pantry Staples

- Almond flour and unsweetened shredded coconut
- Erythritol or xylitol and 100% cocoa
- Unsweetened coconut milk and cream
- Olive oil, coconut oil and butter
- Eggs and cheeses: mozzarella, Parmesan, cream cheese
- Cauliflower, courgette, aubergine, cabbage and kale
- Tinned peeled tomatoes and olives
- Chicken, beef mince, fish and tinned tuna
- Nuts, lemons, fresh herbs and smoked paprika
- Chia seeds and golden flaxseed meal

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CHAPTER 01

Breakfast and Quick Snacks

Start the day with practical, satisfying recipes that do not rely on traditional bread. This chapter brings together eggs, cheese, almond or coconut flour and fruit in balanced portions. Most options require up to 15 minutes of active preparation.

01 Baked Spinach and Cheese Omelette



Preparation 10 min **Total** 30 min **Serves** 2 **Difficulty** easy

385	6 g	27 g	28 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 4 eggs
- 1 cup chopped spinach (fresh or frozen, squeezed dry)
- 50 g grated mozzarella
- 2 tbsp double cream
- 1/2 onion, chopped
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- salt, black pepper and nutmeg to taste

METHOD

1. Sauté the onion in olive oil for 3 minutes, add the spinach and cook until the water evaporates.
2. Whisk the eggs with the cream, salt, pepper and nutmeg.
3. Fold the sautéed mixture and the cheese into the eggs.
4. Pour into a small greased baking dish and bake at 180 °C for 20–25 minutes, until the centre is set.

COOKING TIP: Make two at once: the second one keeps 3 days in the fridge and becomes tomorrow's breakfast.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Swap the spinach for grated courgette squeezed dry — same technique, milder flavour.

02 2-Minute Low-Carb Microwave Bread



Preparation 5 min **Total** 7 min **Serves** 1 **Difficulty** easy

245	4 g	14 g	18 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 egg
- 2 tbsp almond flour
- 1 tbsp double cream
- 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1 pinch of salt
- 1/2 tsp butter for greasing

METHOD

1. Mix everything in a mug or small greased square dish with a fork until no lumps of flour remain.
2. Microwave on high for 90 seconds.
3. Turn out, cut in half and toast in a pan or toaster for 1 minute on each side.

COOKING TIP: It is only good if you toast it: the microwave cooks the bread but gives it no colour and no crumb.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** No almond flour? Use 1 tbsp golden flaxseed meal and 1 tbsp coconut flour.

03 Banana Oat Pancakes (No Flour)



Preparation 8 min **Total** 15 min **Serves** 2 **Difficulty** easy

260	22 g	15 g	12 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 very ripe banana
- 2 eggs
- 3 tbsp oat bran
- 1/2 tsp cinnamon
- 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp butter or coconut oil

METHOD

1. Mash the banana with a fork until smooth.
2. Add the eggs, oats, cinnamon and baking powder and mix well.
3. Heat the butter over low heat and drop small ladles of batter.
4. Cook 2 minutes on each side, flipping as soon as bubbles appear on the surface.

COOKING TIP: The banana should be heavily speckled: that is what sweetens the batter with no added sugar.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Replace the banana with 1/2 grated apple and 1 tsp sweetener to cut the carbs further.

04 Savoury Egg, Vegetable and Bacon Muffins



Preparation 15 min **Total** 35 min **Serves** 6 **Difficulty** easy

180	3 g	12 g	13 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 6 eggs
- 1/2 cup diced bacon
- 1/2 courgette, grated and squeezed dry
- 1/2 cup grated cheese
- 2 tbsp chopped chives
- salt and pepper to taste

METHOD

1. Brown the bacon and drain on kitchen paper.
2. Grate the courgette, salt it, wait 5 minutes and squeeze it firmly in your hands.
3. Whisk the eggs, fold everything together and divide among the cups of a muffin tin.
4. Bake at 180 °C for 20–25 minutes, until firm in the centre.

COOKING TIP: Freeze in a resealable bag and microwave 30 seconds: breakfast is ready in half a minute.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Swap the bacon for shredded chicken for a version lower in saturated fat.

05 Stovetop Tapioca Crepe with Cheese and Tomato



Preparation 5 min **Total** 10 min **Serves** 1 **Difficulty** easy

290	14 g	18 g	16 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 egg
- 1 level tbsp tapioca starch
- 1 tbsp cream cheese or double cream
- 2 slices mozzarella
- 3 thin tomato slices
- oregano and salt to taste

METHOD

1. Whisk the egg with the tapioca, cream cheese and salt until smooth.
2. Heat a non-stick pan over low heat and pour in the batter.
3. Cook 2 minutes, flip, top with cheese and tomato and fold in half.
4. Leave 1 more minute covered so the cheese melts.

COOKING TIP: Low heat is the secret: on high heat the crepe dries out and cracks when you fold it.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Sweet version: fill with 1 tsp peanut butter and cinnamon.

06 Stovetop Cheese Bread



Preparation 5 min **Total** 10 min **Serves** 1 **Difficulty** easy

275	6 g	16 g	21 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 egg
- 2 tbsp sour cassava starch
- 2 tbsp grated parmesan or mozzarella
- 1 tbsp double cream
- 1 pinch of salt

METHOD

1. Mix everything with a fork until you have a creamy batter.
2. Pour into a small greased non-stick pan over low heat.
3. Cover and cook 4 minutes, flip and cook 3 minutes more.
4. Cut in half and fill while hot.

COOKING TIP: Use sour (fermented) cassava starch, not the sweet kind: the sour one gives the characteristic chew.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Go-to filling: cream cheese and oregano, or shredded chicken with cream cheese.

07 Creamy Chicken Collard Wrap



Preparation 12 min **Total** 20 min **Serves** 2 **Difficulty** easy

310	9 g	26 g	19 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 4 large collard green leaves
- 1 cup cooked shredded chicken
- 3 tbsp cream cheese or natural yoghurt
- 1/2 carrot, grated
- 1/2 cup chopped lettuce
- juice of 1/4 lemon, salt and pepper

METHOD

1. Blanch the collard leaves 20 seconds in boiling water, then in ice water: they soften without cooking.
2. Mix the chicken with the cream cheese, lemon, salt and pepper.
3. Assemble on the dried leaf: lettuce, carrot and creamy chicken.
4. Roll tightly like a cigar, folding in the ends, and cut in half.

COOKING TIP: Pat the collard dry with kitchen paper: a wet leaf makes the wrap fall apart in your hand.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Use raw chard leaves instead — crunchier and no blanching needed.

08 Creamy Scrambled Eggs with Avocado and Seeds



Preparation 8 min **Total** 10 min **Serves** 1 **Difficulty** easy

405	8 g	20 g	33 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 2 eggs
- 1 tbsp butter
- 1/2 small avocado, sliced
- 1 tbsp sunflower or pumpkin seeds
- chopped chives, salt and pepper

METHOD

1. Beat the eggs with salt and pepper without whipping them foamy.
2. Melt the butter over low heat, add the eggs and wait 20 seconds without stirring.
3. Pull a spatula from the centre to the edges, repeating until creamy and still wet.
4. Serve immediately topped with avocado, seeds and chives.

COOKING TIP: Take them off the heat while they still look underdone: the pan's residual heat finishes them.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** No avocado? Use 2 tbsp sour cream with lemon.

09 Protein Yoghurt with Nut Granola



Preparation 5 min **Total** 5 min **Serves** 1 **Difficulty** easy

320	10 g	22 g	22 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 170 g whole-milk natural yoghurt
- 1/3 cup chopped mixed nuts (Brazil nuts, cashews and almonds)
- 1 tbsp unsweetened coconut flakes
- 1/2 tsp cinnamon
- 1 tsp sweetener or honey (optional)
- 5 strawberries, chopped

METHOD

1. Toast the nuts and coconut flakes in a dry pan for 2 minutes, stirring constantly.
2. Spoon the yoghurt into a bowl and top with the strawberries.
3. Scatter the warm granola over and dust with cinnamon.
4. Sweeten only if needed: the cinnamon already fools the palate.

COOKING TIP: Never toast granola with your phone in reach: nuts burn in 30 seconds and turn bitter.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Batch it: triple the granola and keep it 15 days in a sealed jar.



CHAPTER 02

Complete Lunches

One-pot dishes, salads that keep you satisfied through the afternoon and smart substitutes for rice and pasta — without tasting like diet food.

10 Simple Cauliflower Rice



Preparation 10 min **Total** 15 min **Serves** 4 **Difficulty** easy

65	5 g	4 g	3 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 medium cauliflower, in florets
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1/4 onion, chopped
- salt and fresh herbs

METHOD

1. Pulse the raw cauliflower until rice-sized, or grate it on the largest holes.
2. Sauté the garlic and onion in olive oil for 2 minutes.
3. Add the cauliflower and stir-fry over high heat for 5–6 minutes.
4. Salt and finish with fresh herbs — do not cover, or it turns to mash.

COOKING TIP: Never process cooked cauliflower: it releases water and turns to paste. Always raw, and pulse.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** A neutral base: it keeps 4 days in the fridge and takes any leftover protein on top.

11 Courgette Noodles with Homemade Tomato Sauce



Preparation 12 min **Total** 30 min **Serves** 2 **Difficulty** easy

265	14 g	12 g	18 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 2 large courgettes
- 6 ripe tomatoes (or 1 tin peeled whole tomatoes)
- 2 garlic cloves
- 1/2 onion
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- basil, salt and pepper
- grated parmesan to finish

METHOD

1. Make the sauce: sauté onion and garlic, add chopped tomato and simmer 20 minutes until thick.
2. Slice the courgette into thin ribbons with a peeler or spiraliser.
3. Sauté the courgette 90 seconds in hot oil — just to warm it, never to cook it.
4. Add the sauce, toss briefly and finish with basil and parmesan.

COOKING TIP: Salt the spiralised courgette, drain 10 minutes in a colander and pat dry: that removes the water that dilutes the sauce.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Swap the peeled tomatoes for a sauce of blended cauliflower with parmesan — lower in carbs still.

12 Garlic and Oil Palm Heart Noodles



Preparation 10 min **Total** 20 min **Serves** 2 **Difficulty** easy

210	7 g	8 g	17 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 jar shredded hearts of palm (or konjac spaghetti)
- 4 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 3 tbsp olive oil
- 1/4 cup grated parmesan
- parsley, black pepper and salt

METHOD

1. Drain the hearts of palm and pat them very dry with kitchen paper.
2. Warm the olive oil over low heat and golden the sliced garlic without burning it.
3. Add the hearts of palm and sauté 3 minutes over medium-high heat to drive off water.
4. Turn off the heat, toss with parmesan, parsley and pepper and serve at once.

COOKING TIP: Hearts of palm and konjac release a lot of water: drying them well before sautéing is what keeps the dish from turning soggy.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Add 1 cup sautéed prawns to make it a complete main.

13 Complete Chicken Salad with Yoghurt Dressing



Preparation 15 min **Total** 25 min **Serves** 2 **Difficulty** easy

340	12 g	32 g	18 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 grilled chicken breast, cut into strips
- 4 cups mixed salad leaves
- 1/2 cucumber, sliced into rounds
- 1 tomato, cut into wedges
- 1/4 avocado
- 170 g natural yoghurt
- 1 tsp mustard, juice of 1/2 lemon, olive oil, salt and herbs

METHOD

1. Season the chicken with salt, pepper and paprika and pan-fry 5 minutes on each side.
2. Divide the greens, cucumber, tomato and avocado between two bowls.
3. Whisk the yoghurt with mustard, lemon, 1 tbsp olive oil, salt and herbs.
4. Top with the warm chicken and dress right before eating.

COOKING TIP: Dressing on the side keeps a salad 2 days in a container; dressed ahead, it wilts in 3 hours.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Swap the chicken for tuna or cooked chickpeas (increase the portion and count the carbs).

14 Tuna Salad with Egg and Lemon Mayonnaise



Preparation 12 min **Total** 20 min **Serves** 2 **Difficulty** easy

375	6 g	28 g	27 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 2 tins tuna in water, drained
- 2 hard-boiled eggs, chopped
- 1/2 cup chopped celery
- 1/4 red onion, chopped
- 3 tbsp mayonnaise
- juice of 1/2 lemon
- 1 tsp mustard, salt, pepper and parsley

METHOD

1. Mix the mayonnaise with lemon, mustard, salt and pepper.
2. Add the tuna, egg, celery and onion and fold gently.
3. Finish with parsley and adjust the salt.
4. Serve over greens, in a collard wrap, or stuffed into a tomato.

COOKING TIP: Celery is what gives the crunch: without it the salad turns pasty.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Grab-and-go: layer it in a jar with the greens at the bottom and the mix on top.

15 Spicy Beef Mince Lettuce Wrap



Preparation 15 min **Total** 25 min **Serves** 3 **Difficulty** easy

320	8 g	26 g	21 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 iceberg lettuce (whole leaves)
- 500 g beef mince
- 1 onion, chopped
- 2 garlic cloves
- 1 small pepper, chopped
- 2 tbsp tomato sauce
- smoked paprika, cumin, pepper and salt
- grated cheese and sour cream to serve

METHOD

1. Sauté the onion, garlic and pepper for 4 minutes.
2. Add the beef mince and brown well, breaking it up with a spatula.
3. Stir in the tomato sauce and spices and cook 8 minutes until the liquid is gone.
4. Serve in lettuce leaves with cheese and sour cream.

COOKING TIP: Pat the lettuce leaves dry: a wet leaf tears when you roll it.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** No beef mince? Use shredded chicken with the same spices.

16 Cauliflower Shepherd's Pie with Shredded Beef



Preparation 25 min **Total** 60 min **Serves** 6 **Difficulty** easy

390	13 g	28 g	25 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 large cauliflower
- 400 g salted dried beef, desalted and shredded
- 2 tbsp cream cheese
- 2 tbsp butter
- 1 onion, chopped
- 3 garlic cloves
- 100 g grated mozzarella
- fresh herbs

METHOD

1. Steam the cauliflower until tender and blend with butter and cream cheese until smooth.
2. Sauté the onion and garlic, add the shredded dried beef and cook 5 minutes.
3. Layer in a baking dish: meat on the bottom, mash on top, mozzarella last.
4. Bake at 200 °C for 20 minutes until golden.

COOKING TIP: Drain the cooked cauliflower well before blending: excess water makes the mash runny.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** No dried beef? Use beef mince sautéed with pepper, or shredded chicken.

17 Aubergine Lasagne Bolognese



Preparation 30 min **Total** 75 min **Serves** 6 **Difficulty** easy

355	12 g	30 g	22 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 2 large aubergines, in thin slices
- 500 g beef mince
- 1 tin peeled whole tomatoes
- 1 onion and 3 garlic cloves
- 200 g sliced mozzarella
- 100 g grated parmesan
- olive oil, oregano, salt and pepper

METHOD

1. Salt the aubergine slices, rest 20 minutes, rinse and pat dry.
2. Fry them in a hot pan with a little olive oil, 2 minutes on each side.
3. Make the sauce: sauté onion and garlic, brown the beef, add tomato and simmer 25 minutes.
4. Layer sauce, aubergine and mozzarella, ending with sauce and parmesan. Bake at 190 °C for 35 minutes.

COOKING TIP: Drying the aubergine is mandatory: skip it and the lasagne releases water and turns to soup in the dish.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Swap the aubergine for thin courgette slices and fry them for less time.

18 Stuffed Aubergine with Beef Mince



Preparation 20 min **Total** 50 min **Serves** 4 **Difficulty** easy

330	11 g	26 g	20 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 2 aubergines, halved
- 400 g beef mince
- 1 onion and 2 garlic cloves, chopped
- 1 tomato, chopped
- 1/2 cup grated mozzarella
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- parsley, salt, pepper and cumin

METHOD

1. Scoop out some of the aubergine flesh, chop it and set aside.
2. Salt the shells and bake at 180 °C for 15 minutes to soften.
3. Sauté onion and garlic, brown the meat, add the chopped flesh and tomato and cook 10 minutes.
4. Fill the shells, top with cheese and return to the oven 15 minutes.

COOKING TIP: Bake the shells before filling: raw aubergine in the oven stays hard inside and burnt outside.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Swap the beef mince for tuna and cream cheese for a 25-minute version.



CHAPTER 03

Soups and Broths

For cold evenings and packed lunches: creamy comfort without potatoes or wheat flour.

19 Low-Carb Kale Soup (No Potato)



Preparation 15 min **Total** 35 min **Serves** 4 **Difficulty** easy

195	9 g	14 g	12 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 small cauliflower, in florets
- 200 g Portuguese sausage or calabresa, sliced into rounds
- 1 bunch collard greens, in thin strips
- 1 onion and 3 garlic cloves
- 1 L chicken stock or water
- 2 tbsp olive oil, salt and pepper

METHOD

1. Brown the sausage in a large pot and reserve some of the fat.
2. Sauté the onion and garlic in that fat for 3 minutes.
3. Add the cauliflower and stock, cook 15 minutes and blend until creamy.
4. Return to the pot, add the sliced collard and sausage and cook 5 minutes without letting the greens turn limp.

COOKING TIP: Collard goes in last and cooks only 5 minutes: it should stay bright green, not brown.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Cured-meat-free version: swap the sausage for shredded chicken and add smoked paprika.

20 Pumpkin Soup with Coconut Milk and Ginger



Preparation 15 min **Total** 40 min **Serves** 4 **Difficulty** easy

180	16 g	5 g	11 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 500 g kabocha squash, diced
- 200 ml unsweetened coconut milk
- 1 (3 cm) piece of ginger, grated
- 1 onion and 2 garlic cloves
- 700 ml vegetable stock
- 1 tbsp olive oil, salt, pepper and chives

METHOD

1. Sauté the onion, garlic and ginger in olive oil for 3 minutes.
2. Add the squash and stock and cook 20 minutes until tender.
3. Blend with the coconut milk until smooth.
4. Adjust the salt, rewarm without boiling and finish with chives.

COOKING TIP: Kabocha has more carbs than other vegetables: mind your portion if you are in the induction phase.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Swap the ginger for curry powder and finish with coriander for a Thai profile.

21 Vegetable Soup with Shredded Chicken



Preparation 20 min **Total** 45 min **Serves** 4 **Difficulty** easy

240	14 g	24 g	10 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 300 g chicken breast
- 1 courgette, diced
- 1 carrot, diced
- 1/2 cup chopped green beans
- 1 cup cauliflower florets
- 1 onion, 2 garlic cloves and 1 tomato
- 1.2 L water or stock, olive oil, salt, bay leaf and parsley

METHOD

1. Simmer the chicken in water with bay leaf and salt 20 minutes, remove and shred.
2. Sauté the onion and garlic separately and return them to the pot with the tomato.
3. Add the carrot and cook 8 minutes; then the courgette, green beans and cauliflower for 8 more.
4. Stir in the shredded chicken, adjust the salt and finish with parsley.

COOKING TIP: Cook the vegetables in order of firmness: carrot first, leafy greens and courgette last.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Freeze in 500 ml jars: it keeps 3 months and rescues an unplanned dinner.

22 Creamy Courgette Soup with Cream Cheese



Preparation 12 min **Total** 30 min **Serves** 3 **Difficulty** easy

175	8 g	8 g	13 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 3 large courgettes, sliced into rounds
- 100 g cream cheese
- 1 onion and 2 garlic cloves
- 600 ml vegetable stock
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- salt, white pepper and nutmeg
- pork scratchings or low-carb croutons to serve

METHOD

1. Sauté the onion and garlic in olive oil until golden.
2. Add the courgette and stock and cook 15 minutes.
3. Blend with the cream cheese until velvety.
4. Return to the pot, season with white pepper and nutmeg and rewarm without boiling.

COOKING TIP: Always add cream cheese off the heat or on low: boiling makes it split and separate.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Swap the cream cheese for 100 ml double cream for a lighter version.



CHAPTER 04

Meat and Poultry

Protein is the foundation of a good low-carb menu: browned, juicy and served with real sauces — never dry meal-prep chicken.

23 Pan-Fried Chicken with Mustard Cream Sauce



Preparation 12 min **Total** 25 min **Serves** 2 **Difficulty** easy

385	5 g	38 g	24 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 2 chicken breast fillets (150 g each)
- 2 tbsp Dijon mustard
- 100 ml double cream
- 1 garlic clove, minced
- 1 tbsp butter
- 1 tsp thyme
- salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. Season the fillets with salt and pepper and sear in a very hot pan, 4 minutes on each side. Set aside.
2. In the same pan, melt the butter and sauté the garlic 30 seconds.
3. Add the mustard, cream and thyme and reduce 3 minutes until thickened.
4. Return the chicken to the pan, coat in the sauce and serve with sautéed vegetables.

COOKING TIP: Do not wash the pan between chicken and sauce: the browned bits are what flavour the cream base.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** No Dijon? Use mild mustard with 1/2 tsp honey or sweetener to balance the acidity.

24 Oven-Roasted Chicken Thighs with Lemon and Rosemary



Preparation 10 min **Total** 50 min **Serves** 4 **Difficulty** easy

410	3 g	36 g	28 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 8 skin-on chicken thighs
- juice and zest of 1 lemon
- 4 rosemary sprigs
- 4 garlic cloves, crushed
- 3 tbsp olive oil
- coarse salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. Mix the olive oil, lemon juice and zest, garlic, rosemary, salt and pepper.
2. Coat the thighs in the marinade and rest 20 minutes, or overnight.
3. Arrange skin-side up on a baking tray without overlapping.
4. Bake at 200 °C for 40–45 minutes until the skin is crisp and the juices run clear.

COOKING TIP: Skin up and not overlapping: that is how skin turns crisp instead of steaming.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Add onion and courgette to the tray for the last 25 minutes to cook a side at the same time.

25 Low-Carb Chicken Stir-Fry



Preparation 15 min **Total** 25 min **Serves** 3 **Difficulty** easy

320	10 g	30 g	18 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 400 g chicken breast, diced
- 1 red and 1 green pepper, diced
- 1 courgette, diced
- 1/2 cup roasted cashews
- 3 tbsp soy sauce (or 2 tbsp soy sauce + water)
- 1 garlic clove and 1 small piece of ginger, grated
- 1 tbsp cornflour diluted in 3 tbsp water (optional)

METHOD

1. Sear the chicken over high heat with a little oil, in two batches, until browned. Set aside.
2. Sauté the garlic and ginger 30 seconds, add the peppers and courgette for 4 minutes.
3. Return the chicken, add the soy sauce and diluted cornflour and toss until coated.
4. Finish with the cashews off the heat so they stay crunchy.

COOKING TIP: Soy sauce carries sodium and some carbs: choose a reduced-sodium version and count 1 g carb per tablespoon.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** No cashews? Use roasted skinless peanuts — cheaper and just as crunchy.

26 Steak with Mushroom Sauce



Preparation 12 min **Total** 30 min **Serves** 2 **Difficulty** easy

430	7 g	38 g	28 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 2 thick-cut fillet or rump steaks
- 200 g button or shimeji mushrooms
- 150 ml double cream
- 1/4 cup beef stock
- 1 tbsp butter
- 1 garlic clove and fresh thyme
- salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. Season the meat with salt and pepper and sear in a very hot pan, 3 minutes on each side. Set aside.
2. In the same pan, melt the butter and sauté the mushrooms until browned and dry.
3. Add the garlic, stock and cream and reduce 5 minutes.
4. Return the meat, warm 1 minute and serve with the sauce poured over.

COOKING TIP: Do not crowd the mushrooms: in a full pan they release water and steam instead of browning.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Cream-free version: use 2 tbsp cream cheese thinned with hot stock.

27 Beef Mince with Courgette and Tomato



Preparation 15 min **Total** 30 min **Serves** 4 **Difficulty** easy

310	9 g	27 g	19 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 500 g beef mince (knuckle or chuck)
- 2 courgettes, diced
- 1 tin peeled whole tomatoes
- 1 onion and 3 garlic cloves
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- oregano, cumin, salt and pepper
- fresh herbs and grated cheese

METHOD

1. Sauté the onion and garlic in olive oil until soft.
2. Add the beef mince and brown well, leaving it undisturbed for 2 minutes to build a crust.
3. Stir in the peeled tomatoes and spices and cook 10 minutes.
4. Add the courgette and cook 8 minutes more until tender but firm. Finish with fresh herbs.

COOKING TIP: Letting the meat brown undisturbed at first is what creates the dark fond and the stewed flavour.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Serve over cauliflower rice, or use it to stuff peppers and courgette.

28 Steak with Caramelised Onions and Garlic Butter



Preparation 10 min **Total** 20 min **Serves** 2 **Difficulty** easy

415	5 g	36 g	27 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 2 rump or sirloin steaks
- 1 large onion, sliced into rounds
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 tbsp butter
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- salt, pepper and chopped parsley

METHOD

1. Season the steaks with salt and pepper and sear in a hot pan with olive oil, 3 minutes on each side. Set aside.
2. In the same pan, brown the onion over medium heat 8 minutes until caramelised.
3. Add the butter and garlic and cook 1 minute without burning the garlic.
4. Return the steaks, coat in the onion, finish with parsley and serve.

COOKING TIP: Take the meat out of the fridge 20 minutes ahead: a cold steak releases water and steams instead of searing.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Add 1 tbsp soy sauce to the onions for a darker, richer pan sauce.

29 Cheese-Stuffed Meatballs in Tomato Sauce



Preparation 25 min **Total** 50 min **Serves** 4 **Difficulty** easy

365	8 g	30 g	24 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 500 g beef mince
- 1 egg
- 3 tbsp almond flour
- 1 garlic clove, grated, parsley, salt and pepper
- 100 g mozzarella, diced, for the filling
- 1 tin peeled whole tomatoes
- 2 tbsp olive oil and basil

METHOD

1. Mix the meat with egg, almond flour, garlic, parsley, salt and pepper. Rest 10 minutes.
2. Open portions in your palm, add a cheese cube and close tightly with no gaps.
3. Brown the meatballs in a pan with olive oil on all sides.
4. Cover with warm tomato sauce and simmer covered 20 minutes over low heat.

COOKING TIP: Seal the meatball tightly: any gap lets the cheese escape into the sauce.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Replace the almond flour with 2 tbsp oat bran (count 2 g extra carbs per serving).

30 Pulled Pork Ribs



Preparation 20 min **Total** 180 min **Serves** 6 **Difficulty** easy

445	6 g	34 g	32 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1.2 kg pork ribs or pork shoulder
- 1 tbsp smoked paprika
- 1 tsp cumin, garlic powder, onion powder
- 1 tbsp apple cider vinegar
- 2 tbsp mustard
- salt, pepper and 2 tbsp olive oil

METHOD

1. Mix the spices with salt and pepper and rub all over the meat along with the mustard.
2. Marinate at least 30 minutes, ideally 12 hours in the fridge.
3. Sear the meat in a hot pot with olive oil to brown all sides.
4. Cover with foil and bake at 150 °C for 2 h 30, or pressure-cook 45 minutes. Shred with two forks.

COOKING TIP: Low and slow is what shreds: high heat only dries out the surface.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Toss the shredded meat with 2 tbsp cream cheese and serve in lettuce wraps.



CHAPTER 05

Fish and Seafood

From Sunday salmon to a quick weekday sardine option: good fats, fast preparation and restaurant-level flavour.

31 Baked Salmon with Lemon Butter



Preparation 8 min **Total** 25 min **Serves** 2 **Difficulty** easy

425	3 g	34 g	30 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 2 salmon fillets (180 g each)
- 2 tbsp melted butter
- juice and zest of 1/2 lemon
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tbsp parsley or dill
- salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. Season the salmon with salt and pepper and place in a greased baking dish.
2. Mix the melted butter with garlic, lemon juice and zest and parsley.
3. Pour over the fish and rest 10 minutes.
4. Bake at 200 °C for 12–15 minutes until opaque and flaking.

COOKING TIP: Salmon is done when it flakes under fork pressure: past that it dries out.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Replace the lemon with 1 tbsp Dijon in the butter for a sharper flavour.

32 Almond-Crusted Tilapia



Preparation 12 min **Total** 25 min **Serves** 2 **Difficulty** easy

390	5 g	34 g	26 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 2 tilapia fillets
- 1/2 cup almond flour
- 1 beaten egg
- 1/2 cup grated parmesan
- 1 tsp paprika
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- salt, pepper and lemon

METHOD

1. Season the fillets with salt, pepper and lemon and pat them very dry with kitchen paper.
2. Mix the almond flour with parmesan and paprika.
3. Dip the fillets in egg, then in the dry mix, pressing to adhere.
4. Bake at 200 °C for 15 minutes on a greased baking tray, or fry in 3 tbsp olive oil, 4 minutes on each side.

COOKING TIP: Drying the fillet before coating is what stops the crust from sliding off in the pan.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Almond flour pricey? Use golden flaxseed meal with the same parmesan.

33 Garlic Prawns



Preparation 8 min **Total** 15 min **Serves** 2 **Difficulty** easy

280	4 g	30 g	16 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 400 g prawns, peeled and deveined
- 5 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 3 tbsp olive oil
- juice of 1/2 lemon
- 1 tsp chilli flakes (optional)
- parsley, salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. Pat the prawns dry with kitchen paper and season with salt and pepper.
2. Warm the olive oil over medium heat and golden the sliced garlic without burning it.
3. Raise the heat, add the prawns and toss 2–3 minutes until pink.
4. Turn off the heat and finish with lemon and parsley.

COOKING TIP: Prawns cook in 2 minutes; beyond that they turn rubbery. Off the heat as soon as they are pink.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Add 1/2 cup white wine and reduce 1 minute for a fancier version.

34 Cod with Cauliflower and Olives



Preparation 20 min **Total** 50 min **Serves** 4 **Difficulty** easy

340	10 g	30 g	20 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 500 g desalted cod, in flakes
- 1 medium cauliflower, in florets
- 1/2 cup black olives
- 1 onion, sliced into rounds, and 4 garlic cloves
- 1/2 cup olive oil
- parsley, black pepper and 1 bay leaf

METHOD

1. Poach the cod 5 minutes, drain and remove skin and bones.
2. Steam the cauliflower 6 minutes, keeping it firm.
3. Sauté the onion and garlic in half the olive oil until golden.
4. Layer in a baking dish with the cod, cauliflower and olives, drizzle with the remaining oil and bake at 190 °C for 20 minutes.

COOKING TIP: Desalt the cod by changing the water every 6 hours for 24–48 hours in the fridge.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** No cod? Use flakes of firm white fish such as hake or tilapia, salted at the time.

35 Fish Moqueca with Coconut Milk and Hearts of Palm



Preparation 20 min **Total** 40 min **Serves** 4 **Difficulty** easy

310	12 g	28 g	18 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 600 g firm white fish in steaks (hake, whiting or sea bass)
- 200 ml unsweetened coconut milk
- 1 jar hearts of palm, sliced into rounds
- 2 tomatoes and 1 pepper, sliced into rounds
- 1 onion, sliced into rounds, 3 garlic cloves
- 2 tbsp dendê (palm) oil, or regular olive oil
- coriander, lemon, salt and pepper

METHOD

1. Season the fish with lemon, salt and pepper and rest 15 minutes.
2. In a wide pot, sauté the onion and garlic, then layer the tomato and pepper.
3. Lay the fish on top, cover with coconut milk and simmer covered 15 minutes on low heat.
4. Add the hearts of palm and dendê oil, cook 5 minutes more and finish with coriander.

> **COOKING TIP:** Do not stir the moqueca after adding the fish: shaking the pot breaks the steaks.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** No dendê oil? Use regular olive oil with 1 tsp smoked paprika for colour.

36 Griddled Calamari with Lemon and Herbs



Preparation 10 min **Total** 15 min **Serves** 2 **Difficulty** easy

240	5 g	26 g	13 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 500 g squid rings
- juice of 1 lemon
- 3 tbsp olive oil
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tbsp parsley and 1 tbsp chives
- chilli flakes, salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. Pat the squid rings very dry with kitchen paper.
2. Heat a griddle pan or barbecue until very hot, almost smoking.
3. Griddle the squid 90 seconds on each side, not one second longer.
4. Dress with salt, raw garlic, olive oil, lemon and herbs and serve immediately.

COOKING TIP: Squid has two windows: 90 seconds, or 40 minutes in a stew. In between, it is rubbery.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** No squid? Use pre-cooked octopus rings, grilled just to brown.



CHAPTER 06

Dinners Ready in 30 Minutes

The evening rule: dinner is ready before the episode ends. One-pan, one-tray and air-fryer recipes for busy nights.

37 Cauliflower Crust Pizza with Mozzarella and Basil



Preparation 25 min **Total** 50 min **Serves** 2 **Difficulty** easy

330	12 g	22 g	22 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 medium cauliflower, riced
- 1 egg
- 80 g grated mozzarella
- 4 tbsp almond flour
- 1/2 cup homemade tomato sauce
- 150 g mozzarella for the topping
- oregano, basil and salt

METHOD

1. Steam the riced cauliflower 5 minutes, cool and squeeze in a towel until all the water is out.
2. Mix the dry cauliflower with egg, 80 g mozzarella, almond flour and salt.
3. Press into a thin round on greased baking paper and bake at 200 °C for 15 minutes.
4. Top with sauce, mozzarella and oregano and bake 10–12 minutes more. Finish with basil.

COOKING TIP: Squeezing the cauliflower is non-negotiable: a wet crust will not hold and the pizza falls apart when sliced.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Freeze par-baked rounds between baking paper and assemble a pizza in 12 minutes.

38 Aubergine Parmesan (No Breadcrumbs)



Preparation 20 min **Total** 50 min **Serves** 4 **Difficulty** easy

300	14 g	18 g	20 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 2 aubergines, in 1 cm slices
- 1 tin peeled whole tomatoes
- 2 garlic cloves and 1/2 onion
- 200 g grated mozzarella
- 1/2 cup grated parmesan
- 3 tbsp olive oil, basil, salt and pepper

METHOD

1. Salt the aubergine slices 20 minutes, rinse and pat dry.
2. Fry in a hot pan with a little olive oil, 2 minutes on each side.
3. Make the sauce by sautéing onion and garlic and simmering the tomato 15 minutes.
4. Layer with the cheeses and bake at 190 °C for 25 minutes until golden.

COOKING TIP: Frying before assembling prevents spongy aubergine that soaks up all the sauce.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Add a layer of beef mince between the aubergine for a complete one-dish meal.

39 Low-Carb Feijoada (No Beans)



Preparation 30 min **Total** 90 min **Serves** 6 **Difficulty** easy

420	8 g	34 g	28 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 500 g mixed meats (spare ribs, paio, sausage, salted dried beef)
- 1 large cauliflower, riced
- 200 g diced bacon
- 1 onion, 4 garlic cloves and 2 bay leaves
- 1 tbsp smoked paprika
- olive oil, salt and pepper
- sautéed collard greens and orange to serve

METHOD

1. Desalt the cured meats for 12 hours, changing the water.
2. Simmer the meats in water with bay leaf 40 minutes, or 25 in a pressure cooker, and cut into pieces.
3. Fry the bacon, sauté the onion, garlic and smoked paprika, add the meats and 2 cups stock and cook 20 minutes.
4. Serve over riced cauliflower sautéed in butter, with collard greens and orange.

COOKING TIP: Cauliflower sautéed in bacon fat is what replaces the texture of beans in the dish.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Express version: use only paio, sausage and bacon — ready in 40 minutes.

40 Air-Fryer Cheese Bread



Preparation 10 min **Total** 25 min **Serves** 12 **Difficulty** easy

130	3 g	8 g	9 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 200 g grated mozzarella
- 1 egg
- 3 tbsp sour cassava starch
- 2 tbsp cream cheese
- 1/2 tsp baking powder
- salt to taste

METHOD

1. Microwave the mozzarella 40 seconds and mix until it forms a dough.
2. Add the cream cheese, egg, sour cassava starch, baking powder and salt, and knead with greased hands.
3. Shape 12 balls and place in the air-fryer basket without touching.
4. Cook at 180 °C for 12–15 minutes until golden.

COOKING TIP: Sour cassava starch, not sweet: the sour one gives the crisp shell and chewy inside.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Freeze unbaked and cook straight from frozen, adding 3 minutes.

41 Tuna and Cream Cheese Stuffed Courgette



Preparation 15 min **Total** 35 min **Serves** 3 **Difficulty** easy

275	8 g	24 g	17 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 3 medium courgettes
- 2 tins tuna, drained
- 4 tbsp cream cheese
- 1/4 onion, chopped
- 1 tomato, seeded and chopped
- 1/2 cup grated mozzarella
- parsley, olive oil, salt and pepper

METHOD

1. Halve the courgette and scoop the core with a spoon, leaving a 0.5 cm wall.
2. Mix the tuna, cream cheese, onion, tomato, parsley, salt and pepper.
3. Fill the shells, drizzle with olive oil and top with mozzarella.
4. Bake at 190 °C for 22–25 minutes.

COOKING TIP: Seed the tomato: that is where the water comes from that floods the filling.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** No tuna? Use shredded chicken or already-cooked beef mince.

42 Low-Carb Sushi (Cucumber Rolls)



Preparation 20 min **Total** 25 min **Serves** 2 **Difficulty** easy

235	7 g	22 g	13 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 large cucumber
- 200 g raw salmon or tuna, in strips
- 3 tbsp cream cheese
- 1/2 avocado, in strips
- 1 tbsp sesame seeds
- soy sauce, wasabi and chives

METHOD

1. Slice the cucumber into long thin ribbons with a peeler or mandoline.
2. Pat the ribbons dry and season with a pinch of salt.
3. Spread the cream cheese, lay the fish and avocado and roll like a cigar.
4. Finish with sesame seeds and serve with soy sauce and wasabi.

COOKING TIP: Salt and dry the cucumber ribbons: waterlogged cucumber loosens inside the roll and it falls apart.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Cooked version: swap the raw fish for prawns or shredded surimi.

43 Cabbage Rolls with Beef Mince



Preparation 25 min **Total** 60 min **Serves** 4 **Difficulty** easy

320	12 g	26 g	19 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 medium cabbage
- 500 g beef mince
- 1/2 cup raw riced cauliflower
- 1 onion and 3 garlic cloves
- 1 egg
- 1 tin peeled whole tomatoes
- mint, cumin, salt and pepper

METHOD

1. Boil the whole cabbage 5 minutes and carefully peel off the leaves.
2. Mix the meat with the riced cauliflower, chopped onion, garlic, egg and spices.
3. Place 1 tbsp filling on each leaf, fold in the sides and roll tightly.
4. Arrange in a pot, cover with blended peeled tomatoes and simmer covered 35 minutes on low heat.

COOKING TIP: Trim the thick leaf rib with a knife before rolling: the cabbage closes without tearing.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Freeze raw between baking paper and cook straight from frozen for 50 minutes.



CHAPTER 07

Sugar-Free Desserts

A real dessert does not need refined sugar: cocoa, coconut, nuts and sweeteners that do not fool your palate.

44 Chocolate Avocado Mousse



Preparation 10 min **Total** 40 min **Serves** 4 **Difficulty** easy

265	12 g	6 g	22 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 large ripe avocado
- 3 tbsp 100% cocoa powder
- 200 ml double cream
- 3 tbsp powdered sweetener (erythritol or xylitol)
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 pinch of salt

METHOD

1. Blend the avocado with cocoa, sweetener, vanilla and salt until perfectly smooth, with no lumps.
2. Whip the cream to stiff peaks.
3. Fold the whipped cream into the chocolate mixture in three additions, lifting from the bottom.
4. Chill at least 30 minutes before serving.

COOKING TIP: The avocado must be ripe: a firm green one leaves a vegetal taste and lumps.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** No avocado? Use 1 cup whipped cream with the cocoa and sweetener, no fruit.

45 Coconut Flan with Erythritol



Preparation 12 min **Total** 55 min **Serves** 8 **Difficulty** easy

190	6 g	8 g	15 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 4 eggs
- 200 ml unsweetened coconut milk
- 100 ml double cream
- 4 tbsp erythritol
- 1/2 cup unsweetened shredded coconut
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 pinch of salt

METHOD

1. Blend all the ingredients for 1 minute.
2. Pour into a mould greased with coconut oil.
3. Cover with foil and bake in a bain-marie at 180 °C for 45–50 minutes.
4. Cool completely and chill for 4 hours before unmoulding.

COOKING TIP: The bain-marie is mandatory: without it the flan bubbles and turns out like scrambled eggs.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Caramelise the mould with 2 tbsp melted xylitol to mimic traditional caramel.

46 Spoonable Low-Carb Chocolate Cream



Preparation 8 min **Total** 25 min **Serves** 6 **Difficulty** easy

145	6 g	4 g	12 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 small carton of double cream
- 3 tbsp 100% cocoa powder
- 3 tbsp erythritol or xylitol
- 1 tbsp butter
- 1 pinch of salt
- chopped 70% chocolate to finish (optional)

METHOD

1. Mix the cream, cocoa, sweetener and butter in a heavy-based pan.
2. Cook over low heat, stirring constantly, for 12–15 minutes.
3. It is done when the mixture pulls away from the bottom of the pan as you tilt it.
4. Turn off the heat, add the salt, transfer to a jar and cool.

COOKING TIP: Erythritol-based sweeteners will not give the same shine as sugar: add 1 tsp coconut oil at the end.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** To make truffles, chill 4 hours, then roll in cocoa powder or chopped nuts.

47 Low-Carb Berry Cheesecake



Preparation 25 min **Total** 70 min **Serves** 10 **Difficulty** easy

285	8 g	9 g	25 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups almond flour
- 3 tbsp melted butter
- 500 g cream cheese, at room temperature
- 3 eggs
- 1/2 cup erythritol
- 200 g natural yoghurt
- 1 cup frozen berries
- juice of 1/2 lemon and vanilla extract

METHOD

1. Mix the almond flour with the butter and press into the base of a springform tin. Bake 8 minutes at 180 °C.
2. Beat the cream cheese with the erythritol until smooth, add the eggs one at a time, then the yoghurt, lemon and vanilla.
3. Pour over the base and bake in a bain-marie at 160 °C for 50 minutes, until the edges are set and the centre still jiggles.
4. Turn off the oven and cool the cheesecake inside for 1 hour. Top with the berries warmed with 1 tbsp sweetener.

COOKING TIP: Cooling inside the turned-off oven prevents the centre from cracking: thermal shock is the culprit.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** No springform tin? Line a regular tin with crossing strips of baking paper so you can lift the cheesecake out.

48 Low-Carb Nut and Chocolate Biscuits



Preparation 12 min **Total** 30 min **Serves** 12 **Difficulty** easy

130	4 g	4 g	11 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup almond flour
- 1 egg
- 2 tbsp melted butter
- 2 tbsp erythritol
- 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 cup chopped 70% chocolate
- 1 pinch of salt and vanilla

METHOD

1. Mix the flour, erythritol, baking powder and salt.
2. Add the egg, butter and vanilla and mix until a moist dough forms.
3. Fold in the chopped chocolate and shape 12 flattened balls on a baking-paper-lined tray.
4. Bake at 170 °C for 12–14 minutes until the edges are golden.

COOKING TIP: They come out soft and firm up as they cool — do not bake longer thinking they are raw.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Keeps 5 days in a sealed jar, or freeze the shaped dough for 2 months.

49 Chocolate Truffles with Coconut Oil



Preparation 10 min **Total** 40 min **Serves** 12 **Difficulty** easy

110	4 g	2 g	10 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 100 g chopped 85% chocolate
- 3 tbsp coconut oil
- 2 tbsp double cream
- 1 tbsp powdered erythritol
- 2 tbsp cocoa powder for rolling
- 1 pinch of salt and a few drops of vanilla

METHOD

1. Melt the chocolate with the coconut oil in a bain-marie or microwave in 20-second bursts.
2. Add the cream, erythritol, salt and vanilla and mix until glossy.
3. Chill 30 minutes until firm enough to shape.
4. Roll into balls with your hands and coat in cocoa powder.

COOKING TIP: Melt in short bursts, stirring every 20 seconds: direct heat scorches the chocolate and makes it grainy.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Keep in the fridge: at room temperature the coconut oil melts and the truffles lose their shape.

50 Low-Carb Peanut Brittle (Paçoca Style)



Preparation 8 min **Total** 20 min **Serves** 12 **Difficulty** easy

115	4 g	5 g	10 g
kcal / serving	carbohydrates	protein	fat

INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups roasted unsalted skinless peanuts
- 2 tbsp almond flour
- 2 tbsp powdered erythritol
- 1 pinch of salt
- 1 tsp coconut oil (optional)

METHOD

1. Pulse the peanuts until sandy and moist — careful not to turn them into butter.
2. Add the almond flour, erythritol and salt and pulse 3 more times.
3. If the mix is too dry, add the coconut oil and mix.
4. Press into small moulds or a baking-paper-lined jar, cut into squares and set 15 minutes.

COOKING TIP: Pulse and stop early: over-processed peanuts turn to butter and the sweet will not set.

↺ **SMART SWAP:** Keeps 10 days in a sealed jar in a cool place.

Bonus 1 — 7-Day Menu

A realistic first-week plan: filling breakfasts, lunches that become dinner and a sweet option at the right time. Numbers refer to recipes in this book.

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Snack	Dinner
Mon	01 · baked omelette	10 + 23 · cauliflower rice with chicken	09 · yoghurt granola	37 · cauliflower pizza
Tue	05 · tapioca crepe	17 · aubergine lasagne	06 · cheese bread	31 · salmon + 44 · mousse
Wed	02 · microwave bread	11 · courgette noodles	45 · coconut flan	35 · fish moqueca
Thu	07 · collard wrap	13 · complete chicken salad	08 · avocado eggs	26 · steak with mushrooms
Fri	03 · banana pancakes	16 · cauliflower shepherd's pie	09 · yoghurt granola	33 · garlic prawns
Sat	04 · savoury muffins	18 · stuffed aubergine	46 · chocolate cream	42 · low-carb sushi
Sun	06 · cheese bread	30 · pulled pork ribs	47 · cheesecake	19 · kale soup + 28 · steak

Adjust portions to your needs. This menu is an educational suggestion, not a prescription.

Bonus 2 — First-Week Shopping List

Print this list and take it to the supermarket. It is designed for two people:

- 2 dozen eggs
- 1 kg chicken breast + 8 thighs
- 1 kg beef mince + 500 g steak
- 600 g salmon or firm fish + 400 g prawns
- 2 tins tuna
- 500 g mozzarella + Parmesan + cream cheese
- Double cream
- 2 containers unsweetened coconut milk
- Cauliflower, courgette, aubergine, cabbage and kale
- Fresh tomatoes + 2 tins peeled tomatoes
- Avocado, bananas, strawberries and lemons
- Onions, garlic, ginger, herbs, smoked paprika
- Olives, hearts of palm, nuts and peanuts
- Almond flour, shredded coconut and chia
- Erythritol or xylitol, 100% cocoa and 85% chocolate
- Olive oil, butter and coconut oil
- Soy sauce and mustard

> **Shopping rule:** visit the fruit and veg counter and the meat counter first; leave the packaged products until last and always check the label.

Before You Close the Kitchen

You now have 50 recipes designed for real life: easy-to-find ingredients, one-pot methods and planned leftovers. The difference between this ebook and a more organised week is one small decision: **your next meal**.

Choose one recipe for tonight, make it and share it with someone. Shared food is easier to repeat.

> **UPCOMING PRACTICAL KITCHEN VOLUMES:** Volume 2 — Low-Carb Meals for the Week · Volume 3 — Sugar-Free Party Desserts.

Stop starting your diet every Monday.

This book brings together 50 recipes for staying low carb without cooking twice: breakfasts that carry you through the morning, lunches that become dinner, soups for cold nights and desserts that need no apology.

- **50 complete recipes** with time, number of servings and estimated macros per serving;
- **Cooking Tip** in every recipe to prevent the most common mistake;
- **Smart Swap** ideas for adapting ingredients;
- **7-Day Menu** and a printable shopping list;
- **Substitution table** for flour, sugar, rice and pasta.

Easy-to-find ingredients. Realistic time. Food for people who do not want to feel on a diet.

PRACTICAL KITCHEN